



# Speech variation under information-theoretic constraints

- How **generalizable** are these findings?
- Most previous studies:
  1. Focused on specific types of variation (duration, merger, lenition, etc.): Are more generally applicable (not restricted to specific variation types)?
  2. Used acoustic data as an estimate of speech production behavior: Would the effects behave differently w/ regard to acoustic & articulatory dimensions of variation?





# General distinctiveness as an estimate of variation

- To investigate the information-theoretic effects on speech variation in an unsupervised way:
- This study focuses on the articulatory & acoustic “distinctiveness” (resilience to variation) between phone bigrams (phone1-phone2) in a word.

